A rate rise is back on the table, and payrolls land Friday

On Friday afternoon the Fed chair said inflation is still too high and that rates **may need to go up. Futures pricing for a September increase roughly doubled within hours. This week then delivers the two biggest activity surveys of the month and the August jobs report.**

CONTENTS

01 The week

Where the week starts, and the one number that moved on Friday. **No forecast figure appears anywhere on this page**, and section 05 says why this week made that rule stronger rather than weaker.

7,722.00	14.43	4.72%	-4.20%	8:30am	~60%
S&P futures, Fri	VIX, from 15.13	US 10 year	Crude oil, week	Jobs report, Fri	Sept rise odds

Where the scheduled risk sits. Times are eastern. Monday is empty, the middle three days each carry a 10:00 release, and the jobs report lands before Friday's open.

MON 31	TUE 1	WED 2	THU 3	FRI 4
Clear	10:00	10:00	10:00	8:30
Nothing scheduled all morning	Factory survey and job openings	Orders, then Broadcom after the bell	Services survey, and the chip reaction	The August jobs report
CLEAR	DATA	TWICE OVER	REACTION	THE DAY

Red top marks the week's main event. Green marks the one morning with nothing scheduled.

02 Friday changed the question

For most of this year the argument was when rates would come down. It is now whether they go up.

- **The chair used his Jackson Hole keynote to say inflation remains above the 2 percent goal and that the central bank may need to raise rates in the coming months. That is a different message from the one the market walked in with.**
- **Pricing for a rise at the September 16 meeting roughly doubled the same afternoon.** (these odds are read off interest rate futures, contracts whose price implies what traders expect the central bank to do) **Futures based readings moved from about 35 percent to between 56 and 60 percent**

depending on the source. Separate betting markets put it lower, at 48 to 49 percent. Both families moved the same way and they do not agree on the level.

- **The two year yield rose as much as 9 basis points to 4.32 percent and the dollar gained 0.4 percent on the day. Short dated yields track policy expectations most closely, so that is the part of the market that reacted.**
- **Over the full week the ten year finished 2 basis points lower. The short end rose on Friday while the long end fell across the week, and those are two different measurements rather than a contradiction.**

03 Three surveys and a jobs report

The calendar is unusually front loaded with activity data, and it ends with the month's biggest number.

- **Tuesday 10:00, the national manufacturing survey**, and **Thursday 10:00, the services survey.** (monthly surveys of purchasing managers, where a reading above 50 means activity grew and below 50 means it shrank) **Services matter more here, because services prices are the centre of the current inflation argument.**
- **Friday 8:30, the August employment report.** (the monthly count of jobs added, published by the Bureau of Labor Statistics, along with the unemployment rate and wage growth) **It is the largest scheduled release of the month and it arrives twelve days before the rate decision.**
- ⚠ **A regional factory barometer collapsed on Friday to 47.1 from 57.6**, a 10.5 point drop and its first reading below 50 in four months. **It is one region with its own panel and it does not forecast Tuesday's national survey. It is named because it is the freshest hard reading the week inherits.**

04 What the market did while that happened

The index rose. Most of the shares in it did not.

- **Cap weighted** (the S&P 500 as usually quoted, where the biggest companies count for more) **rose 0.47 percent while the equal weighted** (the same 500 companies, each counted the same) **version fell 0.44 percent. They closed on opposite sides of zero, and the small company index fell 1.40 percent saying the same thing.**
- **The two prior weeks ran the other way round. A two week pattern reversing is not itself a new pattern**, and this page does not treat one week as a trend.
- The **VIX** (the market expectation of swing over the next 30 days, priced from options. Low means calm is assumed) **closed at 14.43, its lowest of the stretch, on the very session that rate rise odds nearly doubled. Stated as a mechanical fact. No signal is claimed from it.**
- **Crude fell 4.20 percent, ending three consecutive weeks of gains above 5 percent**, as traders reframed the Gulf risk. **Gold gave back 2.04 percent of the prior week's 6.85 percent rise.**

05 What this page will not claim

Three refusals, and the first one got stronger this week.

- **No forecast figure for Friday's jobs report appears above. Two published previews were found and they disagree by 32,000 on the payroll count.** ⚠ **They also name different current unemployment rates while both calling it unchanged, which means at least one of them is wrong about a number that has already been published. The spread is the honest content. No average is taken.**

- **The dealer positioning** (how options market makers are hedged, which shapes whether moves get damped or amplified) **read is unavailable again. ★ But a correction is owed: this page has said for four weeks that the source was offline, and it was not. It published throughout. The real position is narrower, that it carries no positioning data and moves behind a paywall on September 6.**
- **A third party positioning figure was found and rejected for the second week running. It reported a threshold roughly 400 points above where the index is trading and then described the resulting condition backwards. A number that fails its own internal check is worse than a blank.**

THE ONE LINE

The calmest volatility reading in weeks sits directly in front of two major activity surveys, a jobs report, and a central bank that has just said the next move might be upward.

SOURCES & NOTE

Sources: Release dates and times: tradingeconomics.com calendar, live lookup August 30 2026 (page renders UTC, converted at eastern equals UTC minus 4, offset proved against six permanently fixed slots: payrolls, both purchasing manager surveys, jobless claims, the private payroll report and the Beige Book), corroborated in native eastern by the investrade and Newsquawk week ahead calendars; Levels: Yahoo Finance settled daily bars, August 21 and August 28 2026. Rate expectations: CME figures as reported independently by CNBC and Benzinga, August 28 2026. Regional factory barometer: MNI and ISM Chicago publication; Jobs report date and time: bls.gov release schedule, corroborated by two independent previews which agree on the date and disagree on the figures.

Educational, not financial advice. A record of what happened and what is scheduled, for Mann's own discretion.

Glossary

Jackson Hole An annual central banking gathering in Wyoming. The Fed chair traditionally speaks on the Friday.

Basis point bp One hundredth of a percentage point. Nine basis points is 0.09 percent.

Interest rate futures Contracts whose price implies what traders expect the central bank to do.

Purchasing managers survey PMI A monthly survey of businesses. Above 50 means activity grew, below 50 means it shrank.

Payrolls The monthly count of jobs added, published with the unemployment rate and wage growth.

Cap weighted Bigger companies count for more.

Equal weighted Every company counted the same.

VIX The market expectation of swing over the next 30 days, priced from options. Low means calm is assumed.

Dealer positioning How options market makers are hedged. It shapes whether moves get damped or amplified.